Question 3

Inclusive Approach to Software Engineering: a critical evaluation of the class padlet

Common themes. The 45 posts [1] fall into five themes (Figure 1). Diverse perspectives dominates (12 posts), followed by accessibility and reducing bias (11 each): a diverse team "increases the chance of things being caught during code review" (P26) [1]. External evidence supports this: facial-analysis systems built on unrepresentative data misclassified darker-skinned women up to 34.7% of the time against 0.8% for lighter-skinned men [2], echoing P41's call for "including different people in datasets" [1]. Business claims (P6, P22) are backed by McKinsey, who found gender-diverse executive teams 39% more likely to outperform financially [3], although this shows correlation, not causation. Contradicting the majority, posts warn diversity helps only "if handled well" (P8) and that "non-diverse teams can fully consider impact" (P35) [1].

Missing and under/over-represented ideas. Generic "more viewpoints" posts are over-represented, often just "More ideas" (P21). Despite the padlet's title, impacts on actual people are thin: disability, gender and income each appear once, while older, neurodivergent and LGBTQ+ users never appear. Costs to businesses appear once (P31), and no post cites evidence or law such as the Equality Act 2010 [4]. As contributors were one class of computing students, the padlet itself may lack diversity.

Critical use of AI. Copilot themed and visualised the posts [5]. We first merged the export's split "Subject"/"Body" fields. Copilot counted all 45 posts correctly but labelled cautious posts P8 and P43 as benefits and left business with two posts, so after checking every post manually we re-prompted it (Figure 2). All supporting sources were found independently.

Overall, the padlet explains why diverse teams matter but rarely who is affected, so it is a narrow, largely uncritical starting point.

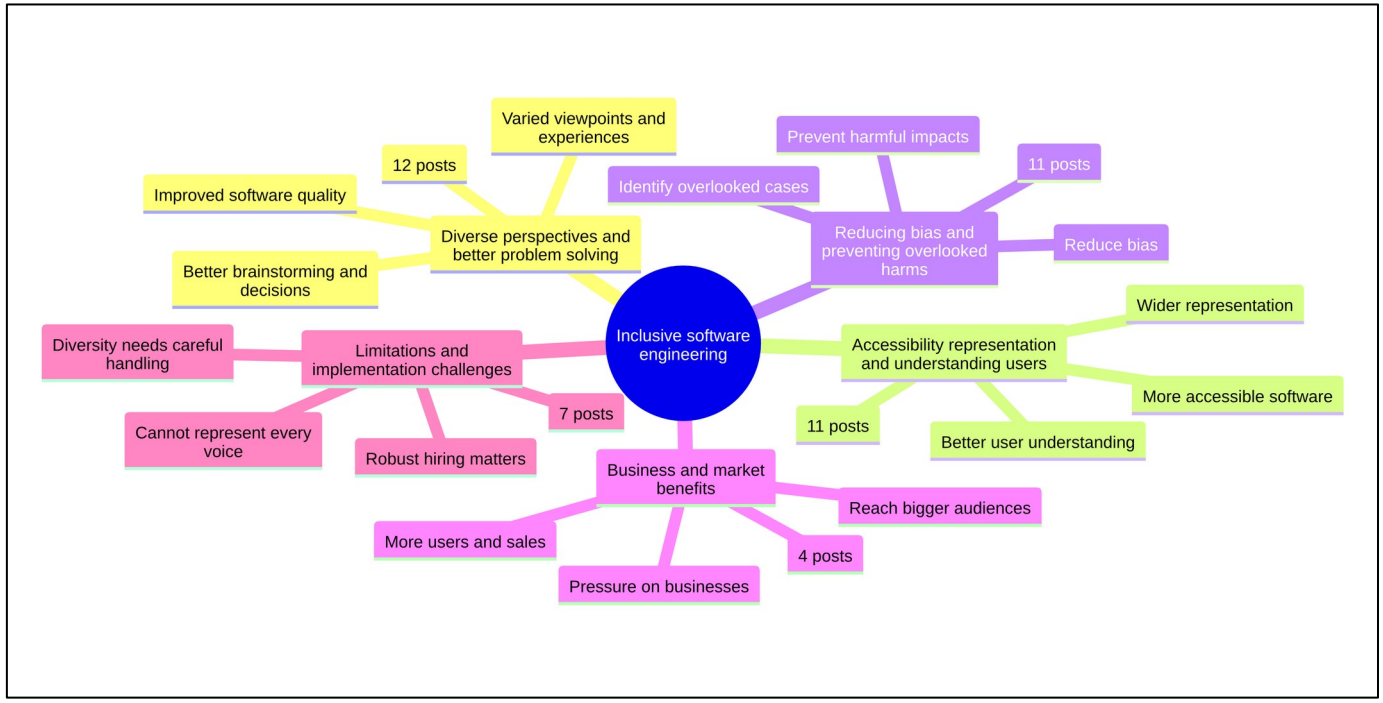


Figure 1: *Copilot-generated mind map of the 45 padlet posts [1], checked and corrected by us [5].*

"there will almost always be someone who could be affected by the software negatively on the team" – P32 [1]

Figure 2: Checking Copilot

Theme: Copilot first → after our check

- Diverse perspectives – 13 → 12
- Accessibility & users – 12 → 11
- Reducing bias – 12 → 11
- Business – 2 → 4
- Limitations – 6 → 7

Moved: P8, P43 → Limitations (cautious, not benefits); P22, P31 → Business.

Who is missing from the padlet?

Posts naming each group (of 45):

- Disabled people – 1 (P3)
- Women / gender – 1 (P12, "a pregnant woman")
- Low-income users – 1 (P18, "digital divide")
- Older users – 0
- Neurodivergent users – 0
- LGBTQ+ users – 0

Over-represented: "more viewpoints / ideas" – 11 posts, many only 1–3 words

Critical or cautious posts: 7 of 45

Posts citing evidence or law: 0 of 45

References (Question 3)

[Merge these into the group's single References page and renumber so citations run in order across Q1–Q3.]

[1] J. Hoey, "Inclusive approach to software engineering: The impacts on people, society, businesses," Padlet, CO3101 Lecture 5, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://padlet.com/jameshoey/cw1q3. [Accessed: 29 Oct. 2026].

[2] J. Buolamwini and T. Gebru, "Gender shades: Intersectional accuracy disparities in commercial gender classification," in *Proc. 1st Conf. Fairness, Accountability and Transparency*, PMLR vol. 81, 2018, pp. 77–91.

[3] McKinsey & Company, "Diversity matters even more: The case for holistic impact," Nov. 2023. [Online]. Available: https://www.mckinsey.com/featured-insights/diversity-and-inclusion/diversity-matters-even-more-the-case-for-holistic-impact

[4] *Equality Act 2010*, c. 15. London, U.K.: The Stationery Office, 2010. [Online]. Available: https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2010/15/contents

[5] Microsoft Copilot, "Thematic grouping and mind map of CO3101 padlet posts," AI chat, 2026. [Online]. Available: [shared Copilot chat link]. [Accessed: 29 Oct. 2026].

[6] Anthropic Claude, "Analysis of padlet posts and drafting of CO3101 CW1 Question 3," AI chat, 2026. [Online]. Available: [shared Claude chat link]. [Accessed: 29 Oct. 2026].

AI use declaration

Microsoft Copilot [5] was used to group the padlet posts into themes and produce the mind map in Figure 1; every post was checked manually against the padlet and errors were corrected. Claude [6] was used to independently count the posts per theme, re-render Copilot's unchanged mind-map code in a light theme, suggest supporting sources and help draft the structure and wording of this answer; all quotes, counts and sources were checked by us against the originals. [Edit to match exactly what you did.]